



Building on or near a boundary

Sheds, carports and walls close to the line — where the rules change, and what the plans must show.

THE 900 MM LINE

For Class 10a buildings, **900 mm to a boundary is the trigger**: closer than that and fire separation applies — the parts of the structure facing the boundary need to be non-combustible or carry the required fire resistance. A steel shed usually satisfies this; timber posts, battens or cladding inside the zone usually don't. Structures clustered close to the dwelling or other buildings on the lot can also bring separation between buildings into play — we check that as part of assessment. Dimension the setback on the plan either way, so the question answers itself.

BUILDING ON THE BOUNDARY ITSELF

- ✓ **Planning first:** boundary walls are governed by the R-Codes boundary-wall provisions for your area's R-coding — length and height limits apply, and in some cases neighbour comment through the council. Marginal? Ask us before you build it into the design — see also note 14, *Planning approval & Class 10*.
- ✓ **Structure:** footings stay inside the lot, clear of (or designed for) anything the neighbour has on their side, and the engineering should say the wall is designed as a boundary wall.
- ✓ **Water stays on your side:** no roof drainage discharging over the boundary — show the gutter and downpipe layout.
- ✓ **Maintenance access:** think about how the boundary face gets built and maintained — a zero-lot wall you can't reach is a dispute waiting to happen.

WHAT WE NEED TO SEE

- Site plan with the setback to every boundary dimensioned — "on boundary" written where it applies.
- Elevations showing height at the boundary.
- Materials of any face within 900 mm of a boundary.
- Engineering matching the site's wind class, noting boundary-wall design where relevant.
- Planning approval, or a note that none is required and why.

The common bounce: "1 m setback" on the drawing, 850 mm once eaves and gutters are counted. Setbacks are measured to the closest part of the structure — gutters included. Dimension to the gutter line and the question never comes back.